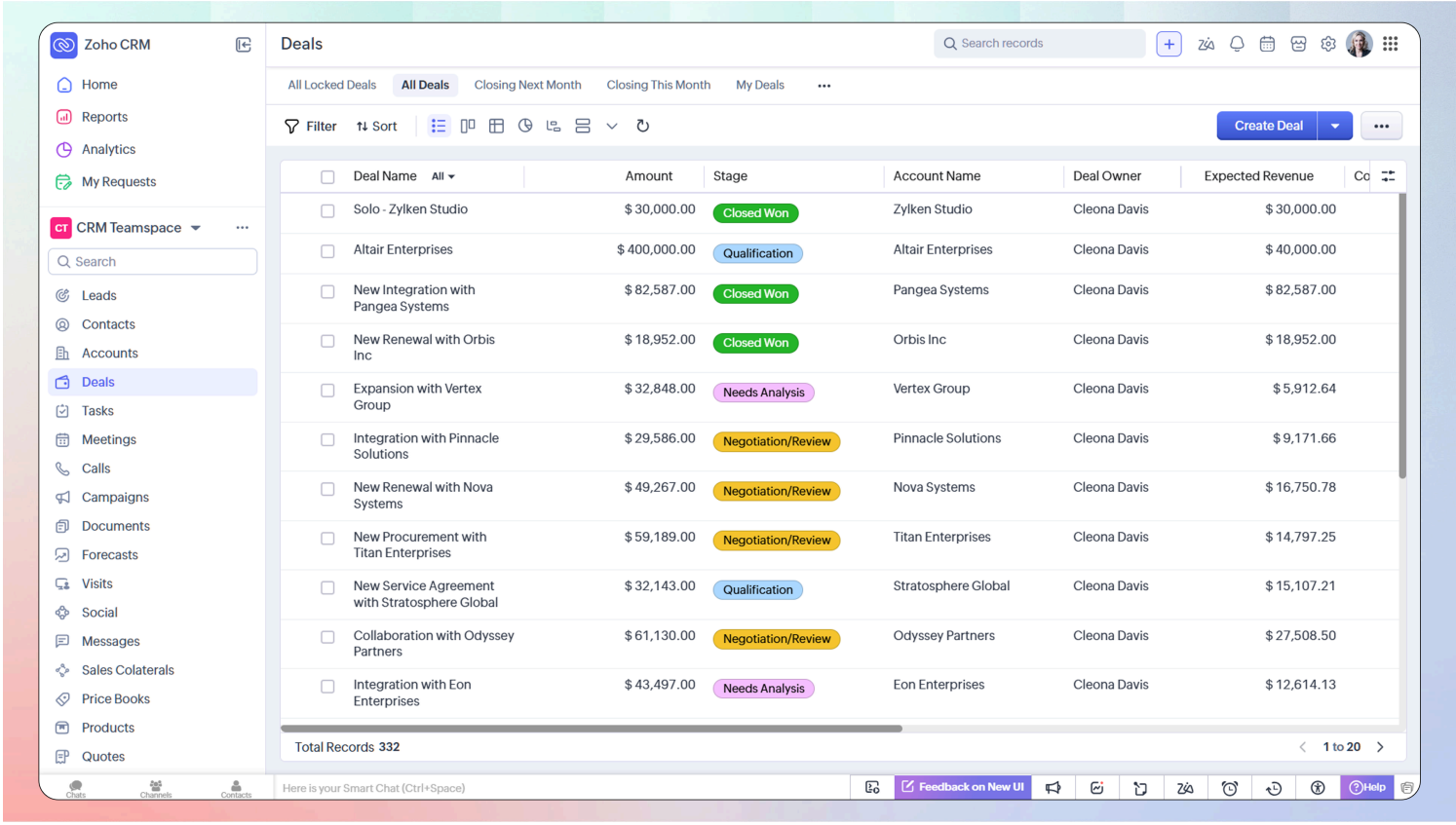
Zoho Corporation

Introduction to Zoho CRM

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Zoho CRM helps you deliver **exceptional customer experiences—without enterprise-sized bloat**. This means you can connect with your customers easily, align your teams, automate busywork, streamline processes, gain insights, and leverage AI—all without high costs, long setups, or heavy staffing.



> This page covers some common questions and offers a bird's-eye view of Zoho CRM. This will be followed by links to relevant documentation to help you learn more and start using the CRM.

What is CRM?

Customer relationship management (CRM) means different things in different contexts.

Fundamentally, it refers to the effort businesses make to understand, manage, and meet the needs of prospects and customers. In other contexts, it's a tool that facilitates this process, namely by performing the following functions:

- Capturing key information and creating a complete view of each customer, which helps ensure that anyone working with the customer can leverage this context to make better decisions and provide better customer experiences
- Helping customer-facing teams stay aligned and manage their work easily via pipeline-structured processes

While the latter definition of "CRM" began as a sales-centric software tool—and while closing deals is still a key component of CRM functionality—sales now involves multiple teams working together. Additionally, many customer-facing teams use CRMs to track all their work in one place, rather than spreadsheets or disconnected tools. Doing so helps keep everyone aligned and empowered with context.

Either way, CRM helps businesses build stronger, more long-lasting relationships with their customers. While people usually mean "CRM" as a tool, the term encompasses both meanings. And Zoho CRM is one of the CRM systems available to meet your needs.

Why do businesses need a CRM?

A business of any size is looking to make a profit. To do this, it needs to acquire and retain customers, manage and pay its employees, and run its operations efficiently.
CRMs help businesses acquire customers and grow those relationships at scale. To this end, CRMs enable the following:

- Unhindered access to customer data
- Inter-departmental coordination
- Streamlined processes and automations
- Proactive participation in customers' journeys
- Intelligent decision-making

Let's follow a business as it grows—from a one-person startup to a heavyweight enterprise—and see how a CRM supports each stage.

Solo startup

Imagine walking into Meena's Kitchen, a friendly and clean local restaurant. The owner welcomes you, checks what you ordered last time, and asks if you'd like it again. You affirm, have a great meal, and leave with a smile as you think about bringing your friends here next week.

Small business

A few years later, you call the new branch of Meena's Kitchen that's opened close to your home. You place a catering order for your child's birthday party. The staff knows your preferences: no onions in the biryani, extra chutney, and less sugar in the fruit juice. The great food arrives on time, nothing is missed, and you receive a thank-you note from Meena. You leave a five-star review online and share a post on social media for daily meals across three campuses, you immediately think of Meena's Kitchen—now a trusted regional catering brand. Their sales team responds quickly, stays organized throughout, and handles the process helps her focus on her food instead of memorizing countless details, as she knows that all customer details

Midmarket chain

A few years later, you're the operations manager at an educational foundation. When a call for bids opens Meena is doing it all: cooking, serving, managing groceries, and remembering preferences. She maintains a list of her customers, their repeat orders, their preferences, feedback, and birthdays—all in her CRM. This

Enterprise

As you can see, the aim of the CRM is to help your business provide great customer experiences at scale. The bigger your business gets, the more instrumental the CRM is in reaching this core objective. Also, note that a CRM is not a silver bullet—it can enhance your people and processes, but it can't replace them.

What are the benefits of Zoho CRM in particular?

As we've mentioned, we want businesses of all sizes to have the capability to provide exceptional CX without bloating CRM licenses unnecessarily. Zoho CRM has some particular attributes that help it achieve this goal:

- **High customizability**: Each business has its own way of working, and Zoho CRM can be customized to fit each one—quickly and at a lower cost thanks to low-code and no-code customization tools like Canvas, Kiosk Studio, Blueprint, and more.
- **Feature-rich**: Zoho CRM is packed with features for automation, process management, journey orchestration, cadences, deduplication, customer portals, ABM, and many more. See What's New to get an idea of what kinds of features we regularly add to Zoho CRM.
- **Flexibility**: Choose the edition you want depending on your needs. Purchase regular user licenses for heavy users and team user licenses for others. Use the CRM alone or as part of CRM Plus (our CX bundle) or Zoho One (our entire business suite). If you feel that Zoho CRM is overkill for your business, you can simply begin with Bigin and move to Zoho CRM when you're ready to scale up. Start with the option you're comfortable with and make changes based on your experience.
- **Integration friendly**: If you're using another Zoho product or a third-party app, you can probably integrate it with Zoho CRM. We support 2,000+ apps in our marketplace, and the list is growing.
- **Extensible**: Sometimes you may need a capability in another tool, but it's not available out of the box and within the scope of our customization tools. In those cases, you can extend Zoho CRM's functionality by using its style of developer tools (APIs, SDKs, functions, widgets, and much more).

For an overview of the different features in Zoho CRM, see Features in Zoho CRM.

Quick start guide

1. **Create a CRM account or log in**

If you don't have a Zoho CRM account, you can sign up for one **here**. By doing so, you can take the CRM for a spin and determine whether it meets your needs. If you'd like to contact our sales team, please email us at sales@zohocorp.com.

2. **Use the CRM**

Signed up and ready to use Zoho CRM for the first time? Let's perform some simple steps to get you started:

a. Learn how to navigate the UI.

b. Invite your team and assign them one of the two basic profiles: admin or standard.

c. Configure your deal pipeline to get a taste of Zoho CRM's customization capabilities. Explore some standard modules.
d. Connect your email account to start sending and receiving emails in Zoho CRM.
e. Create records manually, import data into the Deals module, or migrate your existing CRM data.
f. Integrate other apps to see how they work.
g. Download and explore Zoho CRM's mobile app (Apple / Android).

If you work at a small or medium-sized business and would like to implement Zoho CRM for the first time or are migrating from another CRM, check out this guide:
Implementation guide.

See also

- Get a quick overview of key concepts and Zoho CRM's UI.
- Check out specifications related to Zoho CRM.
- Begin your admin journey and set up Zoho CRM for your users.
- Use our developer docs to extend Zoho CRM.

Support

- Submit a support request.
- Join the CRM community to connect with your peers and learn from them.
- Learn about our support plans.
- View release notes to stay in the loop about newly added features and enhancements.
- Check the status of Zoho apps, including Zoho CRM.
- Looking for training and certification? Check out Zoho Spark.
- Join a live webinar to get an overview of Zoho CRM.
- You're already using our help documentation.
- Contact Concierge (for free!)to learn how Zoho's apps (including CRM) can be used to help your business.

Need help with implementation?

- Connecting with one of our partners can help you drive better business outcomes.
- Jumpstart is a paid service that helps you configure Zoho CRM and get started.
- If you're a mid-sized to large business looking for end-to-end implementation, you can connect with Zoho Enterprise Business Solutions (EBS).

Other resources

- Learn about our policies with respect to various kinds of legal compliance.
- Learn how we offer security to our customers: Security Whitepaper.
- View our stance when it comes to privacy: Privacy Commitment.
- Read about our perspective on building businesses that put people over profits: The Long Game.
- Check out our ebooks about various sales-related topics.
- Learn about the terminology used in Zoho CRM in our glossary.